

Keeping this legacy alive, applications in the cryptocurrency ecosystem have continued to adopt blockchain and develop it further. Besides prominent examples like Bitcoin and Ethereum, many cryptocurrencies use blockchain to power transactions, verification, and other aspects of their financial services. We should also give a special mention to smart contracts, which effectively get rid of intermediaries in digital transactions. In the past years, organizations have been confidently automating transactions using smart contracts.

Despite the enhanced development environment on the Ethereum blockchain, there is a lack of clarity in terms of the legal standing of a smart contract. Due to this factor alone, most projects that use the smart contract functionality on the Ethereum blockchain are experimental. Based on what the authorities decide, 2021 could be when we see widespread adoption of smart contracts. On other hand, traditional and newfound institutions continue to embrace blockchain. Many institutions also aim to integrate blockchain into their infrastructure or open a dedicated sub-sector powered by it.

In addition to many other benefits, the transition to blockchain allows the financial sector to cut down infrastructure costs and offer an innovative financial services portfolio to customers.

▪ NFTs

NFTs are another area where we have seen mainstream adoption of blockchain. Non-fungible tokens, better known as NFTs, have raised the capability of digital tokens to a new level. A platform, a game, or another entity can issue NFTs to its customers who can use these easy-to-handle tokens to prove the ownership of digital art and in-game collectibles. These tokens come in handy when navigating through the gameplay experience. Since each NFT is unique and verifiable, they can effectively store the ownership data. NFTs use blockchain to ensure security. If the recent market transactions tell us anything, more

platforms and games are ready to experiment with NFTs.

In addition to the benefits of security and verifiability, NFTs will help artists sell their work without paying intermediaries. Of course, we cannot underestimate the role of NFT platforms in making this possible. Cryptopunks, Hashmasks,

these creating multipurpose platforms have performed all these years.

Nevertheless, industry experts opine 2021 will see the rise of better adoption of blockchain and customized supply chain management applications. The COVID-19 pandemic has also pushed the healthcare sector to discover the gaps where a blockchain



Cryptokitties, the breakout NFT success story. Read the January 2020 Issue of Digit for more info.

Sorare, The Sandbox, and Axie Infinity are some of the popular projects that have had success with NFTs. Together, these projects have traded values equal to \$325+ million since their beginning. Considering that developers can customize the NFTs according to the specific needs, you can see more of these digital tokens in 2021. The recent years have also seen the rise of ERC-20 token development. Many digital tokens based on the Ethereum protocol have already been integrated into many businesses and platforms.

▪ Supply Chain

Blockchain has had an astonishing impact on the development of supply chain systems. In different sub-sectors like food supply management, shipping management, and even software development, businesses have moved to blockchain. The shift to the blockchain means companies can leverage better transparency and control over transactions. For the time being, companies have to develop custom-designed decentralized apps for their specific supply chain. It is an entirely different story when we consider how

intervention could be highly beneficial. Many companies are said to work on blockchain-based platforms that make it easier to track the development of coronavirus preventive measures and more.

MAJOR COMPANIES WORKING IN BLOCKCHAIN TECH

There are quite a few brand names from the cryptocurrency and decentralized finance sector that have had visible success with blockchain. Coinbase and Binance are two of the major crypto exchanges, and they have been dealing with a significant portion of digital coins and tokens. It is even more critical that these platforms have made cryptocurrencies more accessible. For instance, Coinbase launched a debit card that allows Coinbase users to spend their crypto assets to pay for things at places where VISA and MasterCard are accepted. These exchanges rely on a couple of dozen blockchain platforms, including Bitcoin and Ethereum, to provide cryptocurrency services to customers.

Meanwhile, on the financial services front, we can see a more